

O God, Our Help in Ages Past

Isaac Watts, 1719

St. Anne CM

Attr. to William Croft, 1678-1727

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1. O God, our help, in a - ges past, Our hope for years to come,
 2. Be - neath the sha - dow of Thy throne, The Saints have dwelt se - cure;
 3. Be - fore the hills in or - der stood, Or earth re - ceived her frame,
 4. A thou - sand a - ges in Thy sight Are like an eve - ning gone;

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Our shel - ter from the stor - my blast, and our e - ter - nal home,
 Suf - fi - cient is Thine arm a - lone And our de - fence is sure.
 From ev - er - last - ing Thou art God, To end - less years the same.
 Short as the watch that ends the night Be - fore the ris - ing sun,

5. The busy tribes of flesh and blood,
 With all their lives and cares,
 Are carried downward by your flood,
 And lost in foll'wing years.

6. Time like an ever rolling stream
 Bears all its sons away,
 They fly forgotten as a dream,
 Dies at the op'ning day.

7. O God, our help, in Ages past,
 Our hope for years to come:
 And our eternal home, be Thou
 Our guard while troubles last.